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About

An English-language reference for public transport in Taipei, written because the material exists in Mandarin and nowhere else in a form you can look something up in.

What this is

Taipei's transport network is unusually well documented — in Mandarin. Between 批踢踢 (PTT), Mobile01 and the Chinese Wikipedia there is detailed, argued-over coverage of rolling stock, depot allocations, signalling contracts and construction history. Some of it is better than anything published officially.

In English there is an encyclopedia article per line and a great deal of visitor-facing advice about which exit to use. What is missing is the layer in between: structured reference material you can look a fact up in, with the source attached. That gap is what this site is for.

It is independent and non-commercial. It is not affiliated with Taipei Rapid Transit Corporation, New Taipei Metro, Taoyuan Metro, the Taipei City Government or any bus operator, and it carries no advertising.

How it sources material

Official data where it exists

Station names, codes, running order, coordinates, interchanges, route lengths and end-to-end times come from TDX [<https://tdx.transportdata.tw/>], the Ministry of Transportation and Communications' open data platform. So do the line colours — all 9 of them, from the publishing operator's own line record. None of it is transcribed by hand, and the pipeline that reads it is committed to the repository, so the same figures come out for anyone who runs it.

That decision has already paid for itself twice. Every English-language line colour we could find was wrong, including two cases where a confident correction citing an official map moved *away* from the official value — the working is on the colours page [/data/line-colours/]. And the route length this site published was 1.4 km too long, because it measured geometry that runs past both termini into depot leads, while the operator's own figure sat unread in a field nobody had looked in.

Mandarin sources, synthesised rather than translated

Where official data stops — fleet histories, depot facilities, the Matra contract dispute, why a line was built the way it was — the material is in Mandarin. The policy is to read it, cross-check it, and write it in English from scratch, citing the original in its own language rather than an English mirror of it. Translating a forum thread wholesale would be both a copyright problem and a way of importing its errors without noticing them.

Where sources disagree, the intention is to record every value rather than pick the most plausible one and present it as settled.

TBC rather than a guess

A figure marked *TBC* means nobody here has traced it to a source worth citing. It does not mean the number is unknown to the world. It would be easy to fill those gaps with figures that are probably right, and the site would look more finished; it would also stop being usable as a reference, because you could no longer tell which numbers had been checked.

The same applies structurally. The bus section `[/bus/]` is empty and says so rather than being hidden. Where a figure has been settled since — the two underground Wenhui stations were marked “not established” for four builds and are now named, from the builder’s own record and an encyclopedia agreeing from different directions — the page says how it was settled rather than quietly filling the gap.

Citations, and a count of what has none

Every page carries a source list, and a figure that rests on one says so with a numbered mark you can follow. Each entry records the title in English and in the original language, the publisher, the date the URL was read, and whether the source is **primary** — the operator, the builder, a government department, a court — or **secondary**. That last field is required and has no default: this site has already found a case where a citation to an official route map was further from the published colour than the value it replaced, so who says a thing has to travel with the thing.

Everything cited anywhere is collected in the bibliography `[/data/sources/]`, with the primary-to-secondary ratio stated at the top. It is currently about a third primary, which is not good enough and is published anyway.

The build also counts statements that carry *no* source at all, separately from those marked TBC, and refuses to let that number grow. A labelled gap and an unlabelled assertion are different failures, and only one of them is honest.

What is not used

No operator’s route map, photography or signage artwork. Those are copyrighted. The maps on this site are drawn from published coordinate geometry, and the line colours are the published hex values — a colour specification is a fact, an operator’s specific map is a design.

Data provenance `[/data/provenance/]` sets out field by field what is official, what is researched here, what is derived, and what is still open.

Where it has got to

This is version 1. Every line now has a page written from primary sources, and the Wenhua Line — the first one built, and the one this site went deepest on — also has a page per station, built from official records. 4 of the 31 written pages still carry a stub flag, meaning some figures on them still need tracing to a primary source.

Station pages are Wenhua-only so far. All 180 stations across the network are registered, so any station code on the site validates and any of them can be looked up on the station records page `[/data/stations/]` — but only Wenhua's have a page of their own. Linking a code to a page that does not exist would be worse than not linking it.

Corrections

Corrections are welcome, and specific ones are most useful: the page, the figure, and what it should be, with a source. A source in Mandarin is as good as one in English, and often better.

The most valuable corrections are the ones that catch something stated confidently and wrongly, rather than something already marked TBC — a gap that is labelled is doing its job, but a wrong figure presented as checked undermines everything next to it.

Reporting a correction. Open an issue on the repository this site is built from, quoting the page URL and the figure in question. If you would rather not use an issue tracker, the same information sent any other way is just as welcome — what matters is the source, not the channel.

How it is built

Content is Markdown; the site is generated as static HTML and served as files, with no server and no runtime API calls. Station code badges, Chinese language tagging, strip maps and geographic maps are all produced at build time from the data, which is why a station code that is not real fails the build rather than rendering as though it were.

Station and line data retrieved from MOTC TDX on 2026-08-10. Government open data, used under the Open Government Data Licence.

An independent, non-commercial reference site. Not affiliated with Taipei Rapid Transit Corporation, Taipei City Government, or any bus operator. Line colours are the official values published by each operator through Taiwan MOTC's open data platform. About this site.

Station names, codes and sequence from TDX Transport Data eXchange, Ministry of Transportation and Communications, operator TRTC. Government open data. Retrieved 2026-08-10; source last updated 2020-01-31. Provenance.